

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: It's time to make an appointment by phone!



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you use the telephone?
- Do you set up appointments using the phone? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can identify and pronounce weak forms of words.
- I can set up an appointment.
- I can manage a phone conversation.





Let's Explore!

Can Peter get an **appointment*** with Farmani?

* If you want to change the time of an "appointment", you can call to *rearrange* it.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Receptionist: Mr. Farmani's office. How can I help you?

Peter: Hello, could I speak to Farmani, please?

Receptionist: I'm afraid he's in a meeting until 2 p.m. Can I take a message?

Peter: Well, I'd like to arrange an appointment for Miranda to see him, please. It's Peter Smith here.

Receptionist: Can I put you on hold for a minute, Mr. Smith? I'll just look into the agenda. So when's convenient for you?

Peter: Is he available next Monday? Let's say around 2 p.m.?

Receptionist: I'm afraid he can't on Monday. What about Tuesday at 2 p.m.?

Peter: Ah, that could be awkward. Tuesday's appointments are rather scattered. Is there any possibility of meeting this Friday?

Receptionist: Well, Friday could work. We keep things rather flexible toward the end of the week. Could she meet at 2 p.m.?

Peter: Oh dear, she'll be in the middle of her status update meeting. Is there anything available toward the end of the day?

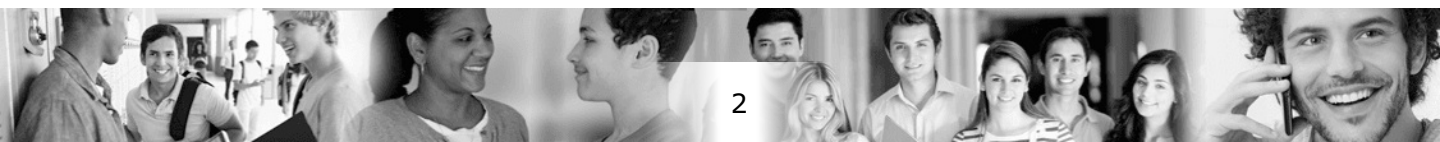
Receptionist: She has her plate full, doesn't she? Let me rearrange a few things ... Is 4 p.m. feasible?

Peter: Fantastic.

Receptionist: Alright. So shall we say Friday at 4 p.m. in your company's office?

Peter: Perfect. Thank you for your time.

Receptionist: You're welcome. Goodbye.





Let's Practice!

Peter makes a phone call. What does he say?

Instructions: Put the sentences in the correct order.

___ Can I put you on hold for a minute, Mr. Smith?

___ Thank you for your time.

___ Can I take a message?

___ Could I speak to Giorgio Farmani, please?

___ Mr. Farmani's office. How can I help you?

___ Goodbye.



Let's Practice!

Can you set up an appointment? I have no time*!

*"no time": Another expression that can be used is to have your plate full, which mean you have a lot of work to do.

Instructions: Write in the missing words. Use capital letters where necessary.

Word Bank

scattered / anything / arrange / about / possibility / friday
/ available / with / awkward / feasible

- Hello, this is Peter. I'd like to _____ an appointment for Miranda _____ Mr. Farmani.
- Is he _____ next Monday at 2 p.m.? I'm afraid he can't on Monday. What _____ Tuesday?
- Hmmm ... That could be _____. Her appointments are rather _____ on Tuesday.
- Is there any _____ of meeting this Friday?
- Is there _____ available toward the end of the day?
- Is 4:00 _____?
- Alright, so _____ at 4:00 p.m.





Extension Activity

Let's make an appointment!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Imagine you have to call an office to make an appointment. Write a dialogue between you and the receptionist.
- Remember to manage the phone conversation.
- Set up an appointment with a manager.
- Remember to include all the necessary information.
- End the phone conversation.
- Practice reading your dialogue aloud.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I manage a phone conversation.

☐
☐

I set up an appointment on the phone.

☐
☐

I pronounce weak forms when I set up an appointment.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **available** (adjective): not busy and has enough time to talk to you
e.g. Is he available next week?
- **scattered** (adjective): spread over a long period of time
e.g. Tuesday's appointments are rather scattered.
- **status update** (noun): information about a situation at a particular time
e.g. Can you give me a status update?
- **awkward** (adjective): difficult to do
e.g. That could be awkward. What about in the morning?
- **feasible** (adjective): something that is possible and is likely to work
e.g. Is 4:00 p.m. feasible?





Learning Points

Pronouncing Weak Forms

In English, we have two different types of words:

- a) **grammatical** or **function** words and
- b) **content** words.

Content words are adjectives, adverbs, nouns and verbs. They are often stressed in spoken English. **Grammatical** words, on the other hand, are small words that basically help us build sentences and connect **content** words and do not carry any meaning. Articles, prepositions, conjunctions, auxiliary verbs, and determiners are all examples of **grammatical** words.

In spoken English, these words have no stress and are often weak. In other words, they are not pronounced as **content** words, which are strongly pronounced ("strong form") and are often pronounced with a schwa sound. This is why they are difficult to hear when people are speaking.

In the following sentences, the weak forms are underlined.

Examples:

- *Mr. Gibbs office. How can I help you?*
- *Could I speak to Michael, please?*
- *I'd like to arrange an appointment for Maria to see him.*

Managing a Phone Conversation

Talking on the telephone can be challenging for a variety of reasons. Firstly, you are not able to see the person you're talking to, so there's no body language to be read. Secondly, it requires a special set of words, phrases, and expressions.

The chart below will help you to speak on the phone confidently in business and personal situations.

Answering the phone

For calls to your direct line

- *Good morning, this is Hannah.*
- *Good morning, Polygon firm. Hannah speaking. How can I help you?*
- *Farmani's office, Hannah speaking.*

For calls to a general number

- *Thank you for calling Polygon. How may I direct your call?*





Learning Points

Introducing yourself

When calling a general number

- *May I speak with Janet Ellison?*
- *Hello, this is Brianne Smith calling for Janet Ellison.*
- *Is Janet Ellison in?*

Connecting someone

When you answer the phone and it is for someone else

- *One minute, I'll transfer you.*
- *Please hold and I'll put you through.*
- *One moment, please.*
- *Just a moment. Can I put you on hold?*

When you don't understand the caller

- *Could you please repeat that?*
- *I'm sorry, I didn't catch that.*
- *I didn't catch what you just said.*
- *Can you speak a little more slowly?*

NOTE:

When talking about using the telephone, note the prepositions we use:

• **on the phone (=talking using the telephone):**

I'm on the phone with Mr. Farmani.

Most teenagers spend hours on the phone every day.

• **by phone/over the phone (=using the telephone):**

We are doing business over the phone.

We take orders by phone or by email.

